HINDUSTAN GROUP

WHERE VISION BECAME VOCATION

No story of Tamil Nadu's educational renaissance is complete without the story of the Hindustan Group, and of the man who founded it. Dr. K.C.G. Verghese was not a product of inherited wealth or political patronage. He was an educator who became a builder — of classrooms, of laboratories, of aspirations. When he established Hindustan College of Engineering in 1985 on the southern outskirts of Chennai, he was making a considered, courageous bet on India at a time when few private actors were willing to stake so much on the future of technical education. The land was difficult, the resources were modest, and the regulatory environment was uncharted. He proceeded anyway, because the cause was clear.

"Education is not a transaction. It is a transformation. The moment a young person walks through our gates, our responsibility is not merely to fill their head with knowledge but to shape their capacity to serve – their family, their profession and their nation."

Dr. K.C.G. Verghese
Founder
Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science

That philosophy animated everything the Hindustan Group built. Over the decades, what began as an engineering college evolved into Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science, a deemed university offering programmes across engineering, architecture, sciences, management and the humanities. Its pioneering work in ocean engineering, marine technology, naval architecture and offshore structures gave it a national distinction in disciplines of direct strategic importance — particularly as India's maritime ambitions expanded across the Indo-Pacific. The institution's investment in research infrastructure, international collaborations and industry-integrated curricula reflected a founder's conviction that Indian education must compete with the best in the world without losing its moorings in Indian values and social responsibility.



Dr. Anand Jacob Verghese
Chairman
Hindustan Group of Institutions

"I have always believed that India's greatest natural resource is its young people. If we educate them well – not just technically but morally, not just professionally but personally – there is no challenge this nation cannot meet. Hindustan was built on that faith, and that faith has never once failed us."

Dr. K.C.G. Verghese
Founder
Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science





Today, Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science — the presenting sponsor of this Southern Education Review — stands as a living testament to those founding convictions. Its sprawling Padur campus is not merely infrastructure. It is intention made concrete. Across faculties of engineering, sciences, arts and social sciences, and management, the institution has produced alumni who lead technology companies, design spacecraft systems, command merchant vessels and practice medicine in hospitals from Chennai to California. Its research output in marine engineering, environmental sciences and computer science has drawn collaborations with institutions in Europe and the United States, placing a Chennai institution on the global research map.

"The world does not need more graduates who know the answers. It needs more graduates who know which questions to ask — and who have the courage and the character to pursue those answers wherever they lead. That is what we have always tried to give our students at Hindustan." — Dr. K.C.G. Verghese

That is, in the end, what Hindustan built. Not just an institution. A disposition. And dispositions, unlike buildings, outlast their builders.